increased quota from the IMF quota reform. Such far-reaching financial power gives China the flexibility and the financial ability of a great power. With the new financial institutions and the G20, China can engage in forum-shopping in this complex and overlapping institutional environment,[64] and it can also expect to implement an exit option when the traditional institutions of global financial governance do not allow space for China's increasing voice and preferences.

Furthermore, the power asymmetry among the BRICS members allows China to keep intra-BRICS dynamics in check. Despite China's cooperative stance within the BRICS, as the very tension between the concurrent establishment of the AIIB and the NDB demonstrates (Chapter 3), China can always introduce alternative choices and competitors if decisions within the BRICS do not go its way.[65] Hence, despite the wishes of the other BRICS to bind China in the BRICS coalition and institutions, China will always maintain its flexibility and freedom of policy choice as the great power. As discussed in Chapter 1, the asymmetrical club structure of the BRICS allows China to reject the demands of the other BRICS if they stray too far from China's preferences.

Pursuit of Prestige and Legitimacy as the Leading Developing Country

A fourth motivation is that acting in concert with the BRICS gives China enhanced legitimacy, prestige, and status as a rising developing country seeking fair multilateral solutions to the challenges of the global economy.[66] China's legitimacy in the global sphere comes first in the form of an increased contribution to global public goods and through the provision of alternative options to Western solutions to financial challenges for the developing world.[67] The NDB, first promoted by (then) Indian Prime Minister Manmohan Singh, has been a good opportunity for China on various grounds. This way, China can contribute to global public goods based on its own principles, not by financing Western interests. Unlike the AIIB, which has a regional focus, the NDB is set up to have a global reach. It also avoids the flaw of slow response by the advanced nations among the G20 in support of the Seoul Development Consensus for Shared Growth, adopted at the 2010 Seoul Summit.[68] Of course, developing countries greatly appreciate the move.[69] In short, the $10 billion initial contribution and later support to the NDB are very much worth China's investment.